



Where Africa and Asia
When 3000–1000 BCE

Among the world's oldest games, mancala is a fast-paced, two-player game of skill and strategy in which pebbles are moved across a board pitted with holes. The aim of the game is to capture the opponent's pebbles. Different versions of this game exist and the rules and number of players can vary across regions.



Ancient board game

Royal Game of Ur



All seven of these pieces need to move across the board.

Where Mesopotamia (modern-day Iraq)
When c. 2600 BCE

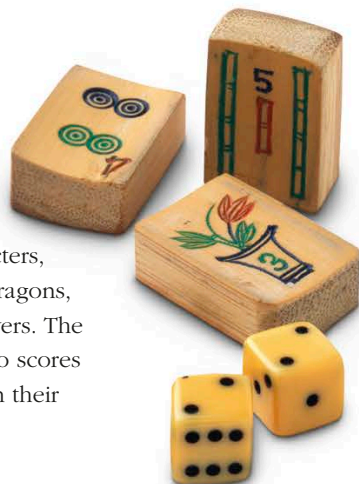
Also known as the Game of Twenty Squares, the Royal Game of Ur has players competing to move their pieces to the other side of the board first, based on rolls of a four-sided dice. Many versions of this board game have been discovered across eastern Europe, the Middle East, and North Africa.

Tile-laying game

Mahjong

Where China
When c. 1850

The classic game of mahjong challenges four players to make sets out of tiles engraved with symbols depicting Chinese characters, circles, bamboo stalks, dragons, winds, seasons, and flowers. The winner is the person who scores the most points based on their final hand of tiles.



Modern board game

Monopoly

Where US
When 1904

US author Elizabeth Magie created The Landlord's Game to explain the unfairness of the property system, and the game later inspired Monopoly. The aim is to move around a board buying up properties, while trying to make opponents go bankrupt. Modern versions of Monopoly feature famous street names from major cities.



Role-playing game

Dungeons & Dragons

Where US
When 1974

The fantasy role-playing game of Dungeons & Dragons invites players to create fantastic stories using their own imaginations. One player is the Dungeon Master, who runs the game and creates the world of the story, while the other players take on the role of heroes to go on quests, battle monsters, and find treasures.



Video game console

PlayStation

Where Japan
When 1994

The first generation of home computer consoles appeared in the 1970s, but gaming technology vastly improved over the next few decades. In 1994, Sony released the PlayStation in Japan. It made history as the first console to sell more than 100 million units, bringing the joy of video games to more people than ever before.

